CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

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Build & Renovate

Roofing · Restoration · Garage Door · Exteriors · General Contracting · Home Building

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

MONEY

Florida insurers had logged 46,509 Isaias claims and about $582 million of insured damage by October 15, with 87% of residential claims still open and unpaid.

Florida's Office of Insurance Regulation (OIR) data as of October 15 show 46,509 claims from Isaias and about $582 million of insured damage, six days after the October 9 Destin landfall. Santa Rosa (22,894), Escambia (13,677) and Okaloosa (4,334) counties produced 88% of the claims. Homeowners claims were 35,014 and $558.6 million of the dollars. Hurricane Sally in 2020 took six weeks to reach 72,000 claims and $577 million.

Modelers were far higher. Cotality put industry-wide insured wind and surge losses at $2 billion to $3 billion on October 12, and Karen Clark & Co. said about $3 billion on October 15. OIR's $582 million is 19% to 29% of that range, but the two are not like for like: OIR counts reported Florida claims, including payments and reserves, six days in, while the models cover the Southeast.

Few claims have turned into money. About 87% of residential claims were open with no payment on October 15. Of 5,545 claims closed, 1,127 were paid and 4,418 were not, and 3,785 of the unpaid closures were for 'administrative reasons,' a new OIR category that covers duplicates, withdrawals and policyholders who could not be reached. Early reports also said much of the damage fell below deductibles.

Door-knocking has followed the storm. Pensacola residents reported a roofing firm and public adjusters in the roofer's shirts promising full replacement, and an agent told them to check with their insurer first (Insurance Journal, October 13). Florida asked FEMA on October 15 for about $237 million in public aid, with nearly 1,000 damaged homes on the individual-assistance list so far.

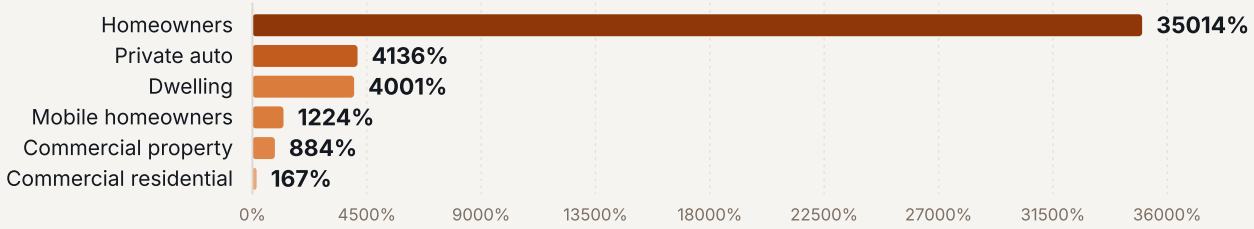
What to do about it: Treat the claim count as a pipeline, not a payday. Before you quote, ask the homeowner for the claim number and the carrier's written scope or denial, and compare the loss to the deductible; do not promise that the insurer will pay full replacement. Put start and completion dates and your payment terms in writing, and take deposits only against scheduled work. With 87% of residential claims unpaid, do not carry homeowners on credit; set a draw schedule that does not depend on the carrier's check. Carry your license and insurance certificate on every canvass, and leave the insurer conversation to the policyholder. Panhandle businesses with storm damage can apply to Florida's Small Business Emergency Bridge Loan, which had approved $4.5 million in no-interest loans by October 19.

Florida Phoenix: Isaias $582M insured damage · Beinsure: OIR claims by line and county, Oct 15 · Insurance Journal: Isaias claims, roofer solicitation

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / ISAIAS CLAIMS

Homeowners policies produced three of every four Isaias claims filed in Florida through October 15.

Claims reported to Florida OIR by line of business, as of Oct 15, 2026 (46,509 total); Beinsure report dated Oct 19, 2026



Homeowners claims were 35,014 of 46,509, or 75%; all residential lines together were 40,406, or 87%. Commercial property was only 884 claims. The roofing and restoration pipeline is a homeowner market, and those are the claims 87% of which were still open and unpaid on October 15. Beinsure: OIR claims by line and county, Oct 15

ROOFING

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

A Texas court ordered Rubinsky Roofing to pay $500,626.64 in restitution and $1.52 million in penalties, and to write start and completion dates into every future Texas contract.

Why it matters: NRCA reported the judgment on October 15; the Collin County court signed it October 5 and the attorney general announced it October 8. The state alleged unnecessary repairs paid with insurance or personal funds and roofs paid for but never finished, and the court found 27 Deceptive Trade Practices Act violations, five against customers 65 or older. The company defaulted by not answering the May suit. This week, put start and completion dates and a deposit schedule in every roofing contract, and keep proof of work started before you collect the next payment.

Texas AG: Rubinsky Roofing repayment order · Dallas Express: Collin County judgment details · NRCA: Roofing company must pay $500,000, Oct 15

MONEY

A pilot by N.C. State, the Job-Site Safety Institute and Comer Construction will test Type II helmets, which often cost more than $100 against about $15 for a traditional hard hat.

Why it matters: NRCA reported the pilot on October 20. Type II helmets add a chin strap and protect the top and sides of the head from falls and struck-by hazards; a Type I hard hat protects the top only. Virginia Tech research suggests Type II protects better against severe injury, and the pilot, with Comer Construction of Forest Hill, Md., aims at smaller firms. At the quoted prices a 10-person crew pays at least $850 more to switch. No requirement to switch has been announced. Price the switch for your crew now and ask your insurer whether it credits the upgrade.

NRCA: Pilot tests Type II safety helmets, Oct 20

RESTORATION

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

Verisk will add a material handling line item to its November 1 Xactimate price lists in the U.S. and Canada, after the Restoration Industry Association asked for it.

Why it matters: Announced October 22, the line item starts at $0 'Each'; the estimator enters a flat job-specific amount, so it is not a preset rate. RIA's point is that a cheaper material price can still cost more to complete a repair, for example from a farther supplier or a purchasing requirement that shifts ordering, pickup and delivery from a subcontractor to the contractor. It does not settle price availability, payment terms or fulfillment responsibility. Before November 1, add a material-handling line to your estimate template, document each sourcing, pickup and delivery task and its cost, and do not duplicate amounts already in the estimate.

R&R: RIA helps deliver Xactimate line item, Oct 22

DEMAND

Vexcel imagery counted about 17,860 damaged structures across Florida, Alabama and Mississippi after Isaias, 3,141 with major damage and 631 destroyed.

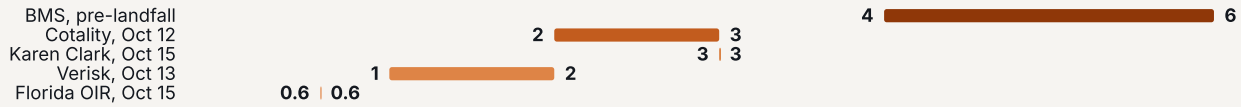
Why it matters: Claims Journal reported the counts on October 19. Karen Clark & Co. puts insured wind and surge loss at about $3 billion, which the article calls comparable to Hurricane Idalia in 2023. Pensacola's mayor reported at least $70 million in private property damage, and Escambia County $64 million to county buildings. At least 14,000 of the damaged structures had less than major damage, so most jobs will be repairs rather than rebuilds. Citizens had 860 claims on about 8,800 Panhandle policies by October 15. Staff for short mitigation jobs, and watch the unpaid-claims rate before adding crews or extending credit.

Claims Journal: KCC puts Isaias at $3 billion, Oct 19 · Insurance Journal: Isaias claims near 47,000, Oct 19

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / LOSS ESTIMATES

Reported Isaias losses of $0.58 billion sit far below every model estimate, which run from $1 billion to $6 billion.

Insured loss estimates, $ billions: BMS (pre-landfall) and Cotality (Oct 12) via Insurance Business; Verisk (Oct 13) via Insurance Journal; Karen Clark & Co. (Oct 15) via Claims Journal; Florida OIR reported (Oct 15) via Beinsure



Karen Clark and OIR are single figures, about $3 billion and $0.58 billion. OIR's total is reported Florida claims, with payments and reserves, six days in; the models cover the Southeast. Even so, it is 19% of Karen Clark's figure. Insurance Business: Isaias loss estimate $2-3 billion

GARAGE DOOR

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Housing completions ran at 1,192,000 in September, 14.0% below a year earlier, a decline Census says is statistically significant.

Why it matters: Census reported September new residential construction on October 20. Single-family completions were 840,000, down 11.0% on the year, also significant. Month to month, total completions rose 2.2% and single-family fell 2.4%, both within sampling error. Homes authorized but not started stood at 279,000, up 9.8% on the year, so a permitted pipeline exists. Plan winter labor on the lower rate, and push replacement and service work, which does not depend on builders' finish dates.

Census: New Residential Construction, Sept 2026 · NRCA: Housing starts fell in September, Oct 22

SUPPLY

Iron and steel prices rose 1.5% in September and stood 20.7% above a year earlier, according to ABC's analysis reported October 20.

Why it matters: ABC's analysis, relayed by NRCA, puts construction materials overall up 2.2% in the month and 11.2% on the year. The 20.7% annual gain compares with 14.2% for softwood lumber. Shorten the validity of door and track quotes, add a material-surcharge clause to any bid older than 30 days, and ask your distributor for its next increase date before you hold prices on a spring season.

NRCA: Construction material prices rose, Oct 20

EXTERIORS

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

GAF stopped selling WeatherSide fiber-cement siding on October 1, and CertainTeed will discontinue numerous vinyl siding and soffit profiles, colors and carpentry accessories by year end.

Why it matters: A distributor's October update lists both discontinuations; Hardie launched Hardie Soffit & Panel on September 28. Anyone with open fiber-cement bids priced on WeatherSide, or warranty and repair work that needs a matching profile or color, faces re-quoting or a substitute. This week, list every open job and callback on those lines, buy the CertainTeed profiles and colors you will need for repairs before year end, and tell customers in writing that matching discontinued product may not be possible.

Universal Supply: October Monthly Update

MONEY

Marvin announced a price reduction of approximately 10% on its Essential window and patio door line, while the distributor's June update listed mostly increases.

Why it matters: The notice appears in a distributor's October update. Ply Gem, Simonton and Silverline had taken 3% to 8% increases on vinyl and aluminum windows and doors from June 1. If you quote Essential windows and patio doors, the lower price may reach your open bids. Ask your distributor for the effective date and whether quotes already placed are covered, re-price pending window jobs once you have it, and do not promise customers a lower price until it is confirmed in writing.

Universal Supply: October Monthly Update · Universal Supply: June Monthly Update

GENERAL CONTRACTING

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

ABC's backlog indicator rose to 8.7 months in September, but contractors with data center work averaged 11.3 months, about three months more than firms without it.

Why it matters: ABC surveyed members September 21 to October 5; NRCA reported the results October 15 and BDC on October 21. Backlog was up 0.2 months from August and from a year earlier. Only 15% of members have data center contracts, and 39% of firms over $100 million in revenue do, against about one in ten under $100 million. Commercial and institutional backlog reached its highest level since July 2025. If you are under $100 million, the average is not your pipeline: measure your own backlog in months of revenue against 8.7 and bid the gaps now.

BDC: Contractor backlog at 8.7 months, Sept 2026 · NRCA: Contractors less confident in September

MONEY

Construction input prices rose 2.2% in September and were up 11.2% from a year earlier, ABC said October 20, and more than one in four contractors expect margins to shrink.

Why it matters: Nonresidential input prices rose 2.3% in the month and 11.2% on the year. Softwood lumber fell 2% in September but is 14.2% above a year ago. ABC's chief economist called the 11%-plus annual gain the largest in nearly four years. In ABC's confidence survey, more than one in four contractors expect margins to contract over six months, the highest share since November 2025. Add price-escalation clauses to any fixed-price contract longer than 90 days, and lock subcontractor and supplier quotes in writing with expiry dates.

NRCA: Construction material prices rose, Oct 20 · NRCA: Contractors less confident in September

HOME BUILDING

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Builder sentiment fell three points to 29 in October, with 43% of builders cutting prices, up from 38% in September, and the average discount holding at 6%.

Why it matters: NAHB's index, released October 20, fell as current sales conditions slipped two points to 33, sales expectations five to 32, and buyer traffic five to 18. NRCA's summary calls the 43% price-cutting share the highest for 2020-26. A further 65% of builders used other incentives, the 19th straight month above 60%. If you build, sub or supply for production builders, expect requests to cut trade-package prices and to absorb incentives. Price your next package with a floor, and tighten payment terms before volume slips.

NRCA: Homebuilder sentiment fell in October, Oct 20

DEMAND

Single-family permits fell 4.0% to an 845,000 annual rate in September, 4.8% below a year earlier, and West starts dropped 23.2% in a change Census flags as significant.

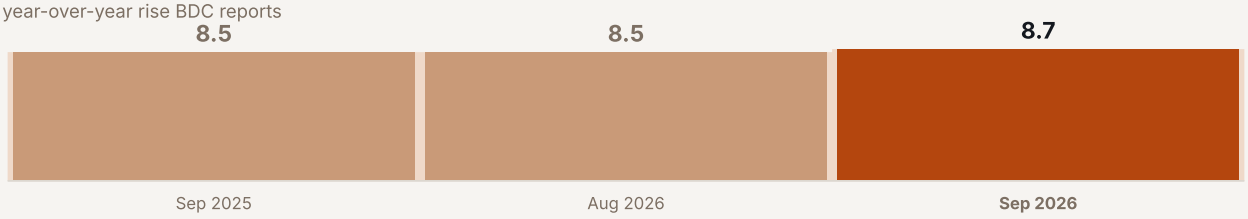
Why it matters: Census reported September new residential construction on October 20. Total starts fell 5.2% to 1,221,000 and single-family starts 4.6% to 859,000, but Census marks both as within sampling error; West starts, down 23.2% on the month and 25.4% on the year, are significant on both counts. Total permits were 1,400,000, down 0.2%. Check your next-60-day schedule against permits issued in your counties, not national starts.

Census: New Residential Construction, Sept 2026 · NRCA: Housing starts fell in September, Oct 22

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / CONTRACTOR BACKLOG

ABC's backlog indicator rose to 8.7 months in September, up 0.2 months from August and from a year ago.

ABC Construction Backlog Indicator, months of work in the pipeline; September 2026 survey (Sept 21 to Oct 5) reported by BDC Oct 21, 2026; August 2026 reading from NRCA Oct 15, 2026; September 2025 is the September 2026 reading less the 0.2-month year-over-year rise BDC reports



The average hides a split: members with data center work carry 11.3 months, and 39% of firms above $100 million have such work against about one in ten below. A smaller contractor reading 8.7 as a floor for its own backlog is reading the wrong number. Measure your own months of work. BDC: Contractor backlog at 8.7 months, Sept 2026

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

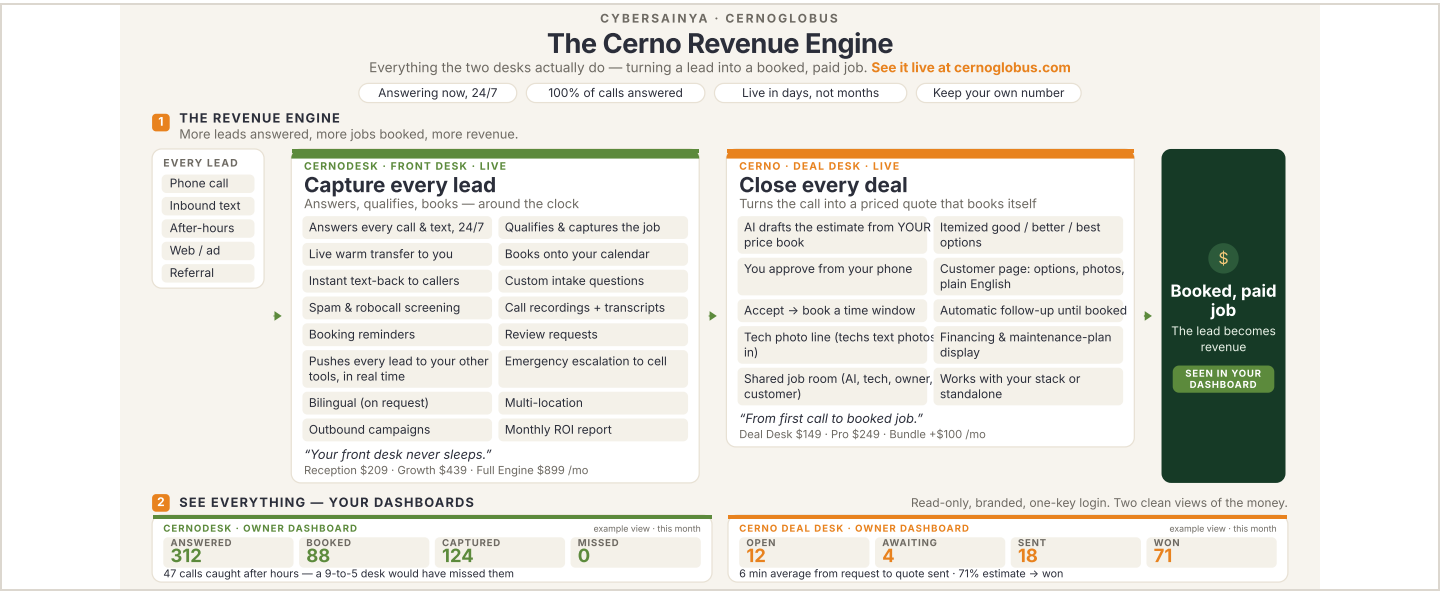
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a builder or remodeler. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails bids, change orders and supplier invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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